

French New Wave breathes new life into movies with *À bout de souffle*, as does British New Wave with *Saturday Night and Sunday Morning*.

↑
1960

The Berlin Wall goes up and the USSR takes the lead in the **Cold War space race** by sending the first man into space, 60 years after *A Trip to the Moon*.

↑
1961

While America's growing **civil rights** movement fights racism, so too does lawyer Atticus Finch in the movie adaptation of *To Kill a Mockingbird*.

↑
1962

Musicals continue to charm: *The Sound of Music* breaks international box-office records.

↑
1965

1960



Italian epic *La Dolce Vita* **spurns conventional narrative** in following one man's search for love and happiness among the café society of Rome.

1962



In the year of the Cuban Missile Crisis, **spy mania** runs amok as 007, British secret agent James Bond, makes his debut in *Dr. No*.

1964



Dr. Strangelove satirizes **Cold War paranoia**, while the Vietnam War escalates and the US introduces the draft.

1966



Shot in **newsreel style**, *The Battle of Algiers* exposes the brutal realities of guerrilla warfare, in an era of decolonization.

Released in the last moments of the 1950s, François Truffaut's *The 400 Blows* was the bridge into the decade to come, and the seismic shake ups that would arrive with it. From the very beginning of the 1960s, cinema was, like its audience, set on breaking rules.

New Wave

The impetus came from Europe, in particular from France, where Truffaut's colleagues from the movie magazine *Cahiers du Cinéma* were creating a whole new language for movies. The era of the *Nouvelle Vague* (New Wave) would be embodied by director Jean-Luc Godard, a gifted ball of mischief who would release his own first feature in 1960: *À bout de souffle* (*Breathless*). Stylish and extremely

“
The film of tomorrow will be directed by artists for whom shooting a film constitutes a wonderful and thrilling adventure.
François Truffaut
”

witty, it immediately made everything that had come before look hopelessly old-fashioned.

All this was at a time when many observers thought cinema was dying, doomed by the spread

of TV in Western homes during the 1950s. Cinema's response was thrilling. Many of the greatest movies of the era were born out of a mood of bubbling outrage. In the US, the young genius Stanley Kubrick took a jab at the ongoing insanity of the Cold War with *Dr. Strangelove*, in which Peter Sellers paid homage to Alec Guinness's multitasking in *Kind Hearts and Coronets* by playing three different characters. Later, as demands for change coursed around the world, the Italian director Gillo Pontecorvo would influence a generation of filmmakers with the incendiary *The Battle of Algiers*.

Counterculture

Elsewhere, the politics were less overt but the air just as thick with restlessness and the rejection of